

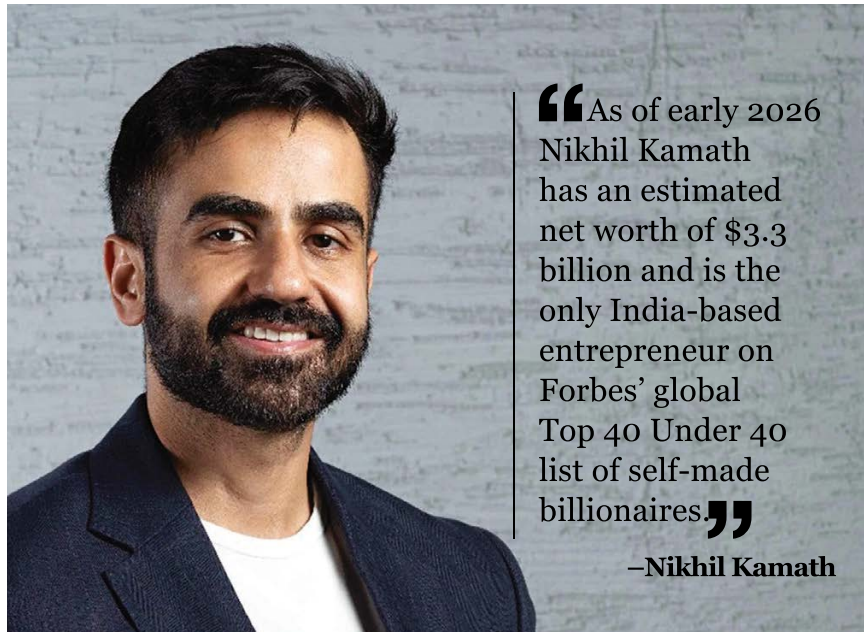
Nikhil Kamath: Investor And Entrepreneur Zerodha

Parents who are super obsessed with studies, and the onward journeys as career professionals, of their wayward wards, can take heart from Nikhil Kamath's story. Ditching the tag of a high school dropout with Zerodha he rose to rank amongst the world's best-known self-made finance billionaires. Looking back on his own unorthodox journey in finance Kamath shares how "Our education system pushes people towards more conventional career paths."

But it was no magic wand which created this grand transformation. For the 16th year old lad. "Entrepreneurship requires a completely different mindset. It's a skill set that needs to be nurtured," he points out. Having an idea is just the beginning; bringing it to life is the real challenge, he shares, having seen plenty of that on his own journey.

A schooldays hustle of selling off a cell phone gave him that first taste of the power of persuasion and money. Sudden discovery led to a stop in these shenanigans, but not his curious mind. Having quit school, he worked the night shift at a call centre where another side hustle presented itself in the form of stock trading. His successes were further augmented when the commissions started pouring in from handling the investments of his co-workers. By the time he was 19 he co-founded Kamath Associates to manage High Net Worth Individual portfolios in the public market space. In 2010 he roped in his brother Nithin to co-found Zerodha.

Zerodha, one of India's largest retail brokerage platforms, was the big leap that became a steppingstone to subsequent success stories such as True Beacon, an investment management firm and Gruha a venture capital fund which supported startups in sectors like AI,



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climate, and media. It targeted a global group of Ultra High Net Worth strategic investors. As of early 2026 Nikhil Kamath has an estimated net worth of \$3.3 billion and is the only India-based entrepreneur on Forbes’ global Top 40 Under 40 list of self-made billionaires.

Having tasted success early, despite not following a well-planned path in finance, Kamath's lessons came from his gut feeling and ability to find the sneaky gaps in a well-oiled system. His ability to break the rules to create something better, along with a keen desire to democratise wealth creation with easy access to financial markets for individuals themselves, has been at the heart of Kamath's success story.

Kamath built Zerodha completely from scratch, without an iota of external funding. Zerodha is a compelling low-cost service, technology-driven platform for the masses with nearly 10 million users. True Beacon, a zero-fee asset management firm, only profits when clients do. The WTFund

he launched in April 2023 supports ventures that fuse profitability and sustainability and inspire entrepreneurship among Indian youth. It was an excellent move to tap India's burgeoning youth population comprising 66 per cent of its population of 808 million below the age of 35.

Shedding light on the pathways he chooses, Kamath says: "A lot of the ventures that I push come from responding to a genuine need I identify - a need for better content, backing local home-grown brands in promising sectors, or fostering entrepreneurship in the country."

An environmentalist and philanthropist of note, Kamath, through Zerodha, has committed \$100m to the Rainmatter Foundation, a key supporter of climate change solutions. He has also signed the Young India Philanthropic Pledge, a commitment by India's new age philanthropists to dedicate a minimum of 25% of their wealth to enhance global change, starting with India.